YOU ARE THE CEO OF YOU

THE HIGH SCHOOL JOURNAL

Build habits. Find your direction. Create your future.

30 ENTRIES

MARK HANNA

WHY I WROTE THIS

When I walked into high school as a freshman, I was already living in my third home.

My great-grandparents were my legal guardians. They were born in 1912 and 1915. I didn't have my mom or dad raising me. I had lost my grandmother when I was 10, in fourth grade, and my grandfather when I was 12, in seventh grade.

I was young, but I had already learned that life could change before you were ready.

By ninth grade, I felt like I had to grow up. I was thinking about more than getting through high school. I was thinking about the life waiting on the other side.

Who was I going to become? How would I support myself? What kind of future could I build?

Back then, I felt like I had one shot to get it right.

I know now that life gives us chances to learn, recover, and start again. But at that age, the pressure felt real. Every decision felt connected to my future.

So I paid attention.

I asked adults for help. I looked for guidance. I watched people who were doing well and tried to understand how they got there. How they spoke. How they worked. How they treated people. What they did when something went wrong.

I didn't know everything. I knew I couldn't afford to stop learning.

Somewhere along the way, I started thinking about the family I hoped to have one day. I hadn't met them yet, but I wanted to make them proud. I wanted to become someone they could count on.

That gave my choices a purpose.

It helped me look beyond what felt good in the moment and think about what would help me years later.

I'm sharing this because I know a student can walk into a classroom carrying a whole life nobody sees.

You may be worried about your grades. Your friends. Fitting in. What happens after graduation. You may be dealing with problems at home that make it hard to focus on any of those things.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your story deserves to be understood.

YOUR FUTURE DESERVES ATTENTION

I don't know your whole story. But I understand what it feels like to be young and carry more than people realize.

That is where this journal comes from.

I want to help you see possibilities you may not have been shown yet. To recognize your strengths. To ask for help without feeling ashamed. To learn skills, make thoughtful choices, and build a future that matters to you.

You are the CEO of you.

You won't control everything that happens. You won't get every decision right. But you can learn to lead yourself through the choices in front of you - and find people who will help you along the way.

If you've made mistakes, you still have a future worth building.

If you feel behind, you can take a step from where you are.

If you don't know what you want to become, start by becoming someone you can count on.

Whether you're a freshman or a senior, your future deserves your attention.

I'm still building mine. Let me share what I've learned so you can start building yours.

Mark Hanna

HOW THIS WORKS

READ: 30 short entries. Read at your pace. Try one small action at a time.

DAILY: Start small. Do the action. Notice what helped.

WEEKLY: Reuse the tools after Entries 5 and 7, whatever entry you are reading.

REVIEW: Check your company at Entry 2, after Entry 15, and at Entry 29. Plan ahead in Entry 30.

Your writing is personal. In a group, share only what you choose. You do not need to disclose private family or money details.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Ask for help. Take your next step.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

MAKE THE COMMITMENT

> **You can start leading yourself before you have everything figured out.**

You do not need to own a business to be the CEO of you.

CEO means the person who leads a company. Here, your company is you: your time, choices, health, money, friends, skills, and future.

You are learning how to lead that company. High school is a good place to practice. I want to show you how to start.

That starts with small things. Bring what you need. Start the assignment. Ask the question. Do what you said you would do.

You will make mistakes. I have made plenty. Learn from them and make your next choice better.

Some things are outside your control. Asking for help is part of leading yourself, too.

You don't need your whole life figured out. You need a place to start.

Sign the commitment on the next page. Pick one promise you can keep today. Let's start building.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

One promise kept is a real beginning.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

MY COMMITMENT

> **Make a promise you are ready to practice.**

I commit to building my personal company.

I will take responsibility for my choices and ask for help when I need it.

I will keep learning, practice useful skills, and give my work an honest effort.

I will respect myself and others, even when fitting in feels difficult.

I will own mistakes, repair what I can, and make my next choice with care.

I will remember that my future is worth preparing for.

I will keep building, one good choice at a time.

SIGNATURE

DATE

THE SMALL PROMISE I WILL KEEP TODAY

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Begin with one promise kept.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

BUILD YOUR DEPARTMENTS

> **You can improve a department without judging your whole life.**

You forgot an assignment. That does not mean your whole life is a mess. It means one part needs a better plan.

A company has departments: different parts with different jobs. Your personal company has these eight:

Time and Habits: Plan your day. Repeat helpful actions.
Leadership: Make choices. Own your part.
Money: Know what you spend and save.
Health and Energy: Care for your body and mind.
Relationships: Build good friendships. Accept help.
Reputation: Be someone people can trust.
Learning and Growth: Try things. Build skills.
Purpose: Know why your future matters to you.

You can add another part, like faith or creativity.

You don't have to improve all eight today. Look at each one. Pick the part that needs your attention first.

I'm going to walk you through it. One department, one useful change, one step at a time. Let's build a strong foundation.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A score gives you information, not your worth.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

YOUR STARTING POINT

> **Tell the truth about how things are going.**

Score each department from 1 to 10. 1-3: needs support now. 4-6: uneven. 7-8: mostly steady. 9-10: strong and maintained. Use this same guide each time.

Evidence means something real. Example: Time = 4; I missed two planned homework blocks. Your circumstances and support matter, too.

Department	Score	Evidence from my life
Time and Habits		
Leadership		
Money		
Health and Energy		
Relationships		
Reputation		
Learning and Growth		
Purpose		

THE ONE DEPARTMENT I WILL WORK ON FIRST

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your company can grow from an honest starting point.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

GIVE YOUR COMPANY A DIRECTION

> **Choose one priority. Keep room to learn who you are.**

You do not need eight goals or a final career decision. Begin with one department. You can update the plan when you learn more.

THE KIND OF PERSON I WANT TO BECOME

ONE YEAR FROM NOW, I WANT TO BE BETTER AT...

MY FIRST PRIORITY DEPARTMENT

A TRUSTED PERSON I CAN ASK FOR GUIDANCE

Your rhythm: one useful action each day; a board meeting each week; a checkup after Entry 15; and a company report at the end. You can read ahead without rushing the practice.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Start where you are, with the support you can find.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | GOALS

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

GIVE YOUR GOAL A NEXT STEP

> **A goal becomes useful when you know what to do next.**

You want to make the team. Improve in math. Speak up in class. Those are goals worth working on.

Now give your goal a first step.

"Get better at math" is a start. "Practice five problems after school and ask about the one I don't understand" tells you what to do.

That's what working backward means: start with the goal, then find the small actions that can help you reach it.

Here's what I want you to do: choose one goal for now. Write what you want to improve, one way to notice progress, and when you'll take the next step.

A practice session or an assignment turned in can count. You control your effort more than every final result.

Your Time and Habits department turns a wish into work you can do. Start small enough to start today.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Give one important goal a place to start.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | GOALS

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

TURN A GOAL INTO A PLAN

> **Turn one goal into a step you can schedule.**

Choose one goal. Name a milestone and an action you can schedule.

MY GOAL, WHY I CARE, AND WHEN I WILL CHECK IT

WHAT I WILL COUNT: WHERE I AM NOW AND WHERE I WANT TO BE

MY NEXT SMALL STEP: WHEN AND WHERE

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Put the next step where you will see it.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | SCHEDULING

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

MAKE TIME FOR WHAT MATTERS

> **Your calendar should fit your real life.**

You get home, check your phone, grab a snack, and suddenly it's late. Your homework is still waiting.

Let me tell you: being organized with your time can change your day. Give it a plan before it fills up.

Use a paper calendar or your phone. Add school, travel, meals, chores, work, practice, and rest. Then put one short work block into the space you actually have.

Be clear: "At 6:30, I'll work on my science assignment for 15 minutes."

I wake up at 4:30 a.m. because it works for me. You don't need my schedule. You need one that fits your life and protects your rest.

Leave room for things to run late. If everything won't fit, ask for help deciding what can move.

Your Time and Habits department needs a plan you can follow. Build tomorrow's plan before tomorrow arrives.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Make room for life, not just assignments.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | SCHEDULING

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

GIVE YOUR NEXT DAY A PLAN

> **Make room for the things that already fill your life.**

MY ONE IMPORTANT ACTION FOR THIS DAY

Include school, travel, meals, work, activities, family duties and rest. Put the plan in the calendar you use.

Time / length	What I will do

WHAT CAN MOVE / WHO CAN HELP IF THE PLAN IS TOO FULL

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Leave yourself some breathing room.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | ROUTINES

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

DON'T GIVE YOUR PHONE THE WHOLE DAY

> **Help yourself make the choice you want to repeat.**

You open your phone for one message. A few videos later, the time you needed is gone.

Let's change the setup.

A habit is something you do again and again. Packing your bag at night is a habit. Checking your phone every few minutes can become one, too.

I want you to notice one thing you keep doing that slows you down. Give it a better replacement.

Try this: "After dinner, I'll put my phone away, check my assignments, and start one task for 15 minutes."

Put the notebook where you'll see it. Make the helpful choice easier to make. If you need your phone for family or work, keep those messages available and quiet the rest.

Use the habit tracker. Miss a day? Come back at your next chance.

Your Time and Habits department gets stronger through practice. You are building a routine, one repeat at a time.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Make the next useful choice easier.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | ROUTINES

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

REPLACE ONE HABIT

> **Give a helpful habit a time and a place.**

Choose a habit that supports your goal. Use the tracker after this entry.

ONE HABIT THAT SLOWS ME DOWN

WHAT I WILL DO INSTEAD AND WHEN

MY SMALLER STEP FOR A HARD DAY

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Come back at the next planned opportunity.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

YOUR DAILY CEO CHECK-IN

> **A short check-in can give the day some direction.**

Copy these headings into a notebook or print this page again. Keep the daily check-in short. Give the actions time to become a practice.

BEFORE THE DAY: ONE PRIORITY AND WHEN I WILL WORK ON IT

AFTER THE DAY: RESULT / LESSON / NEXT STEP IF UNFINISHED

MY SEVEN-DAY HABIT TRACKER

Choose one to three habits. Label days 1-7 with dates. Circle planned days before the week; mark done with a check and missed with a dash. Leave unplanned days empty.

Habit / planned days	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Follow-through: _____ done / _____ planned. Three practices out of four planned = 3 / 4. Do not count rest days as misses. Return at the next planned opportunity.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A missed day does not have to become a missed month.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | FOLLOW-THROUGH

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

START THE PART IN FRONT OF YOU

> **You do not have to finish everything to begin something.**

The assignment looks huge. You don't know where to start. So you avoid it, and it keeps hanging over you.

Take a deep breath. Start one piece.

Read the directions. Write the first three ideas. Solve the first problem. You don't have to finish the whole thing to make a start.

Choose a short work block. Get what you need. Put one distraction away. Give that piece your attention.

If you're stuck, ask a clear question: "Can you show me how to start question two?" Getting help can move you forward.

When your time is up, notice what you finished. Give the next piece a time, too.

Your Time and Habits department grows when you follow through. One finished piece is something real to build on.

Get started. You'll thank yourself later.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Starting gives you something to build on.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | FOLLOW-THROUGH

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

FINISH ONE USEFUL PIECE

> **Choose a piece of work with a clear finish line.**

Choose a piece of work from your goal and give it a focused block.

THE TASK AND THE FIRST PIECE I WILL FINISH

WHEN I WILL START / ONE DISTRACTION I WILL PUT AWAY

WHAT I DID / THE NEXT PIECE

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Finish this piece. Then choose the next.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | REVIEW

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

NOTICE THE SMALL WINS

> **Give yourself credit for progress you can point to.**

You asked a question in class. Packed your bag without a reminder. Finished the task you kept putting off.

I want you to celebrate that. It counts. Enjoy the small step forward.

Big changes are built from small actions. You don't have to wait for a trophy or a perfect report card to notice progress.

Ask what helped the win happen. Was your phone out of reach? Did you start earlier? Did someone explain the part you didn't understand?

Keep the thing that helped. Change the thing that got in the way.

Once a week, use your board meeting page. A board meeting here just means a few minutes to look back and plan ahead.

Your Time and Habits department needs that check. Did your plan work? What will you try next?

You can read ahead. Let the habits grow through practice. Small wins add up when you keep building.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your effort deserves an honest look.

DEPARTMENT: TIME AND HABITS | REVIEW

Make time. Build habits. Follow through.

LOOK BACK. BUILD FORWARD.

> **Notice what helped a useful step happen.**

A small win	What helped it happen

ONE THING I WILL KEEP DOING

ONE THING I WILL CHANGE

Use the weekly board meeting after this entry once a week, even if you read ahead. Review actions, not just pages read.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Keep the lesson as well as the win.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

YOUR WEEKLY BOARD MEETING

> **Ten honest minutes. Three clear promises.**

Meet once a week, whatever entry you are reading. Check your calendar, tracker and goal number. Copy or print this tool for continued use.

Last week's promise	Kept / part / no	Evidence / next step

MY PROGRESS NUMBER: BEFORE / NOW / LESSON

This week's promise	When / where

SUPPORT I NEED / NEXT MEETING TIME

Ask someone you trust to check one promise if useful.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Give your promises a plan and a review.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

ONE RESULT IS NOT YOUR WHOLE STORY

> **A disappointing result can help you choose your next move.**

You studied, but the grade was lower than you hoped. You tried out, but didn't make the team.

That hurts. It also isn't the end of your story.

Your Leadership department is learning what to do when a plan doesn't work.

Take a little time. Then look at what happened. Did you need different practice? A clearer explanation? Another way to try?

Ask someone who can help: "What is one thing I can work on before my next attempt?"

Some results are outside your control. A team has limited spots. You can still build the skill and explore another opportunity.

I have failed at things I cared about. I am still building. So can you.

Change the plan if you need to. Get help. Give yourself another chance to learn. One result does not decide who you can become.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A result can change your plan, not your worth.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

CHOOSE YOUR NEXT MOVE

> **Separate what happened from what you tell yourself.**

Separate the result from your identity. Choose a useful response.

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT I CAN CHANGE / WHAT I CANNOT CHANGE

MY NEXT STEP AND WHO CAN HELP

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can ask for another way forward.



DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

THINK PAST THE MOMENT

> **You can pause before someone else chooses for you.**

"Come on. Everyone is doing it."

Maybe it's skipping class. Sharing a cruel post. Going somewhere you don't feel safe. In that moment, fitting in can feel like everything.

Here's what I want you to remember: the people pushing you won't live every result of your choice. Pause. Give your future a vote.

Your Leadership department helps you choose before the group chooses for you. Think about who could get hurt and what the choice could cost.

Practice a short response: "I'm not doing that." "That's not for me." "I need to go."

Have a trusted adult you can contact when you need help leaving a situation.

Trying a new club can feel uncomfortable, too. Learn the difference between being nervous about growing and being pushed into something harmful.

If you've already made a mistake, ask for help and work on what you can repair.

You belong in your own future. Protect it with your choices.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your future gets a voice in this choice.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

MAKE A CHOICE YOU CAN STAND BY

> **Give yourself a choice before the pressure arrives.**

THE CHOICE I AM FACING

Option	What could happen	Effect on my future
A		
B		

A CLEAR RESPONSE I CAN USE

A TRUSTED ADULT / SAFE WAY TO ASK FOR HELP

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A prepared response can help you choose.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

SET YOUR STANDARD

> **Your standard should show up in what you do.**

A classmate offers you the answers. You want the points. You also know you haven't learned the work.

This is a chance to choose your standard.

A standard is a rule you choose to live by. "I'll ask for help instead of handing in someone else's work" is one you can practice.

Your Leadership department needs clear rules. Tell the truth. Come prepared. Let people know when your plan changes.

I want you to be proud of how you do things. Pick one standard that matters to you. Think about where it will be hardest to follow. Decide what you'll do in that moment.

If a teacher's rules about working together or using technology aren't clear, ask first.

You will fall short sometimes. Own it, correct what you can, and try again.

You are building the kind of person you want to be. Give yourself a rule worth practicing.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Practice the person you want to become.

DEPARTMENT: LEADERSHIP

Choose thoughtfully. Own your part. Ask for help.

WRITE A STANDARD YOU CAN SHOW

> **Make your expectation clear enough to practice.**

Write one clear expectation and how you will practice it.

ONE RULE I WANT TO LIVE BY

WHAT I WILL DO TO FOLLOW IT

WHAT I WILL DO IF I GET IT WRONG

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A standard becomes real through practice.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

KNOW WHERE YOUR MONEY GOES

> **Learning to manage a little gives you useful practice.**

You had money. You bought a snack, something in a game, and a few things with friends. Now it's gone.

Your Money department needs three simple numbers: what came in, what went out, and what is left.

Write them down. Paper works. A simple list on your phone works, too.

Separate needs you help pay for from extras you choose. Then look for one purchase you could change to support a goal.

Some students have jobs or help at home. Others don't have money to manage yet. Use your own numbers or the practice example on the next page. Keep family details private.

You don't need a lot of money to start learning about it.

I have learned that earning money and managing money are different skills. Practice managing it now. Your future self can use that skill.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Clear numbers give you a place to begin.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

YOUR MONEY SNAPSHOT

> **Give the money a simple, honest record.**

Use your own numbers or this practice example: $50 available; spend $10 on a need and $15 on extras. What remains? Choose a realistic savings amount from that remainder.

Money snapshot	Amount $
Money I have / received	
Needs I am responsible for	
Extras	
Money remaining after spending	
Amount I choose to save	
Unassigned money after saving	

ONE CHANGE THAT FITS MY SITUATION

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Use the numbers without judging yourself.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

MAKE THE TRADEOFF VISIBLE

> **Something you want today can cost part of another goal.**

Your friends have something new. Yours still works, but now you want the new one, too.

My advice: give yourself time to think before you buy. Make sure it's something you want, not just something you feel pushed to have.

Your Money department helps you see what one choice means for another goal.

Say you've saved $80 toward a $120 goal. Spend $40 today and you'll have $40 left. You'll need more time to reach the goal.

You might still choose the purchase. Make the choice with the numbers in front of you.

Could you wait? Find a lower-cost option? Decide you don't need it?

You are allowed to enjoy your money. You are also allowed to say, "I'm saving for something else."

You don't need to buy what everyone else buys to belong. Practice choosing where your money goes. That is a skill worth taking into adulthood.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can choose what your money supports.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY
Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

THINK BEFORE YOU SPEND

> **Look at what a purchase would ask you to give up.**

Make the tradeoff visible before deciding.

WHAT I WANT TO BUY AND ITS TOTAL COST

WHAT ELSE I COULD USE THE MONEY FOR

MY CHOICE AND WHY

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can wait while you think it through.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

GIVE YOUR FUTURE A REAL PLAN

> **Big dreams deserve practical questions.**

A vehicle. Your own place. Travel. Training for work you enjoy.

I want you to see what is possible for your life. Let's start learning what it takes to build it.

Choose one thing you want to understand. Find out its cost, what you'll need, and who can help you learn more.

A vehicle costs more than its price tag. A class may need books, supplies, or travel. Your Money department learns to look at the whole cost.

You do not need to solve every future bill today. Ask one useful question.

Want to earn college credit in high school? Ask your counselor what your school offers, what it costs, and how the credit could fit a later program.

Write down what you learn. Leave a blank where you still need an answer.

Big plans become clearer when you start learning the details.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A useful question can open a new direction.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY
Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

RESEARCH ONE FUTURE STEP

> **Replace a guess about the future with a useful question.**

Research one real opportunity. Leave unknown numbers blank until you check them.

ONE THING I WANT TO LEARN ABOUT MY FUTURE

COSTS OR STEPS I NEED TO CHECK

WHO OR WHAT I WILL CHECK / ONE QUESTION

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You do not need every answer to ask a good question.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

YOUR FIRST MONTHLY MONEY PLAN

> **Practice with a small amount before the numbers get bigger.**

Use money you actually manage, or make a practice plan. Keep family financial details private. These are planning categories, not amounts everyone should spend.

Money for this month	Plan $	Actual $
Available money / income (A)		
Needs I am responsible for		
Extras I choose		
Total spending (B)		
Money left: A minus B (C)		
Amount I choose to save (D)		
Unassigned or short: C minus D		

MY SAVINGS GOAL / ONE CHANGE I CAN MAKE

A shortfall means the plan needs attention. If there is no room to save, learning the numbers and asking for support are useful first steps.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Use your money plan to learn, not to compare.

DEPARTMENT: MONEY

Know your numbers. Learn to plan.

WHAT WILL MY NEXT STEP NEED?

> **Find the facts before you promise the time or money.**

THE FUTURE OPPORTUNITY OR GOAL I AM RESEARCHING

What I need to find out	What I learned / source
Up-front cost or requirement	
Other costs / time / transport	
Deadline or next available start	
Support or assistance to ask about	

AN UNKNOWN I WILL CHECK / WHO CAN HELP

THE NEXT ACTION AND WHEN

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Preparation begins with a question you can investigate.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY

Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

TAKE CARE OF THE PERSON DOING THE WORK

> **Your company needs a CEO who gets care, too.**

You stay up late, rush out the door, and spend the day tired. Then you get upset because it's hard to focus.

I want you to take care of yourself. You are the person doing all this work.

Your Health and Energy department includes your body, feelings, food, movement, and rest.

Start with one helpful choice you can make. Pack a meal. Take a walk. Step away from your phone. Make time to wind down at night.

You don't need someone else's body or workout. Find movement that fits you. A sport can be one way; it isn't the only way.

If something hurts or you keep feeling unwell, tell a trusted adult. A school nurse, counselor, or health professional can help.

You matter beyond your grades and achievements.

Choose one way to care for yourself. Give it a place in your day. Your company needs you.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You deserve some of the care you give others.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY

Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

CHOOSE ONE ACT OF CARE

> **Choose care that fits your actual life.**

Area	One realistic act of care
Rest	
Movement	
Meals / hydration	
Emotions / support	

THE ONE CHANGE I WILL START WITH AND WHEN

A TRUSTED ADULT OR PROFESSIONAL WHO CAN HELP

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Start with the care available to you.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY

Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

DON'T TURN COMPARISON INTO YOUR BOSS

> **Someone else's progress does not erase your own.**

Someone posts a great game, a high grade, or a perfect-looking weekend. You start feeling like you're behind.

Remember: you're seeing one piece of their life.

Your Health and Energy department includes the words you say to yourself. Pay attention to them.

"I'm terrible at everything" won't help you practice. Try, "This is hard for me right now. I can learn and ask for help."

I look in the mirror and tell myself, "You are a winner." Find words you believe, then give those words an action.

I'm still building, even when people think I've already made it. Be happy for someone else. Keep working on your own next step.

Now use the midpoint checkup. Look back at your first scores. Notice one thing you've changed and one part that needs attention.

You are building your company. Give your own progress a fair look.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your path deserves your attention, too.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY
Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

GIVE YOURSELF A FAIRER RESPONSE

> **Give respectful words an action to stand behind.**

Use respectful words and back them with an action. Then do the midpoint checkup.

WHAT I AM COMPARING OR SAYING TO MYSELF

KINDER, HONEST WORDS I CAN USE

ONE ACTION TO GO WITH THOSE WORDS

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can speak to yourself with respect.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

YOUR MIDPOINT CHECKUP

> **Pause to learn before adding more work.**

Copy your Entry 2 scores. Same guide: 1-3 needs support; 4-6 uneven; 7-8 mostly steady; 9-10 strong and maintained. Score the evidence, not your worth.

Department	Start	Now	Evidence / what changed
Time and Habits			
Leadership			
Money			
Health and Energy			
Relationships			
Reputation			
Learning and Growth			
Purpose			

MY PRIORITY: KEEP, CHANGE OR ASK FOR HELP

THE NEXT ACTION I WILL PUT ON MY CALENDAR

A REMINDER FOR YOU

An honest checkup can make the next week better.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY

Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

RECHARGE BEFORE YOU RUN EMPTY

> **Taking a break can be a responsible part of your plan.**

School. Practice. Chores. A job. Messages. Another assignment.

You keep saying yes, and now you feel worn out.

Your Health and Energy department needs room to recharge.

Look at your week. What can move? What can you ask for help with? Talk before everything piles up: "These things overlap. Can you help me make a plan?"

Then choose a break that helps you feel rested. Listen to music. Draw. Step outside. Spend time with someone you trust.

Notice the difference between resting and scrolling so long that you lose sleep.

You do not have to fill every minute to be serious about your future.

If feeling overwhelmed keeps getting in the way, tell a trusted adult or counselor.

I want you to be productive and give yourself room to recharge. A good plan makes room for both. Put some rest on your calendar.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Rest belongs in a life you can keep living.

DEPARTMENT: HEALTH AND ENERGY
Care for your body, emotions, and rest.

MAKE ROOM TO RECHARGE

> **Build a week with room to recover.**

Make one change that gives your week more breathing room.

HOW I KNOW I NEED A BREAK

WHAT CAN CHANGE / WHO CAN HELP

WHEN I WILL REST AND WHAT I WILL DO

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You are allowed to need support.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS

Build support. Communicate with respect.

BUILD A TEAM THAT HELPS YOU GROW

> **Good relationships have room for respect and honesty.**

Who makes you feel like you can grow? Who listens? Who is happy when something goes well for you?

Those are people worth making time for. I want you to build good friendships and be a good friend in return.

Your Relationships department is about building a good team around you and being a good teammate yourself.

Put your phone down when someone is talking. Ask how they're doing. Listen to the answer. Keep your promises.

Friends can disagree and make mistakes. Look for people who treat you with respect and will work through problems.

Your team can include a teacher, coach, counselor, relative, or another trusted adult.

If you're still finding your people, try one connection through a class, club, sport, or shared interest. You don't need a huge group.

Choose one person to check in with. A simple "How are you doing?" can be a good place to start.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can build belonging one connection at a time.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS

Build support. Communicate with respect.

BUILD YOUR SUPPORT TEAM

> **Invest in one connection that matters.**

Person / trusted adult	How we support each other

ONE INVITATION, CHECK-IN OR REQUEST I WILL MAKE

HOW I WILL BE PRESENT AND FOLLOW THROUGH

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A small invitation can begin a connection.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS

Build support. Communicate with respect.

LEARN TO SAY WHAT YOU MEAN

> **Clear communication is a skill you can practice.**

You don't understand the work, but you stay quiet. Later, you're stuck and upset.

I want you to learn to speak up sooner. You don't have to be mean. You do need to be clear.

Your Relationships department gets stronger when people understand what you need. Start with one clear sentence.

"I'm stuck on the first step. Could you show me an example?"

"Can we decide who is doing each part of the project?"

Say what you mean with respect. Then listen. Clear communication goes both ways.

Speech, debate, drama, student council, and class presentations can give you practice. So can introducing yourself or asking a question after class.

Being nervous doesn't mean you can't do it. Prepare your first sentence. Speak slowly enough to be understood.

Choose one conversation to practice. Your voice will be useful in school, work, and life. Start using it one clear sentence at a time.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your voice gets stronger with practice.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS

Build support. Communicate with respect.

PREPARE YOUR FIRST WORDS

> **Prepare your message. Leave room to listen.**

Prepare a clear request, question, or introduction you can use.

WHAT I NEED TO SAY OR ASK

THE FIRST SENTENCE I WILL USE

WHAT I NEED TO LISTEN TO / OUR NEXT STEP

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Clear words can make room for understanding.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS
Build support. Communicate with respect.

YOU ARE ALLOWED TO HAVE BOUNDARIES

> **A clear limit can protect your time, safety, and respect.**

A friend wants to copy your work. Someone expects you to answer every message right away.

Let me remind you: you can care about people and still set a limit. Your time and your goals matter, too.

A boundary is a clear limit about what you will do or accept. Your Relationships department needs those limits.

"I'll help you understand it, but I'm not sending my answers."

"I'm doing homework now. I'll reply later."

Use clear words. You don't need to be mean or explain the same limit all night.

A friend may feel disappointed. Notice whether they can still respect your choice. If pressure turns into threats or makes you feel unsafe, involve a trusted adult.

Respect other people's limits, too. Their time, privacy, and belongings matter.

Practice one respectful no. It can protect time and energy for something you care about.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A respectful no can protect an important yes.

DEPARTMENT: RELATIONSHIPS
Build support. Communicate with respect.

SAY YOUR LIMIT CLEARLY

> **Be clear about what you can and cannot offer.**

Choose one boundary that protects something important.

THE LIMIT I NEED

THE WORDS I WILL USE

WHAT I WILL DO NEXT / WHO CAN HELP

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your limits deserve respect, too.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

YOUR NAME GOES WITH YOUR CHOICES

> **Build trust in person and online.**

A picture goes into the group chat. It's embarrassing for someone. You could share it or stop it with you.

Your Reputation department is working right there.

Reputation means what people learn to expect from you. My word matters in my work, and yours matters here. Build a name that stands for honesty and respect.

Before you post or send, pause. Is it true? Is it yours to share? Could it hurt someone? Messages can travel farther than you meant them to.

In person, keep your word. If you can't do what you promised, say so early.

It has taken me years to build trust in my work. Small actions, repeated over time, helped build it.

If you hurt someone, own it and work on the repair. You can learn and change.

Your next choice is a chance to show the kind of person you're becoming.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Give people reasons to trust your choices.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

CHECK WHAT GOES WITH YOUR NAME

> **Pause before you put your name on it.**

THE MESSAGE, POST OR PROMISE I AM CHECKING

- ☐ I checked whether it is true or clearly my own opinion.
- ☐ It respects other people's privacy and dignity.
- ☐ I am comfortable taking responsibility for my part.
- ☐ If it is a promise, I understand what I am agreeing to.
- ☐ If unsure, I can pause and ask a trusted adult.

A CHANGE I WILL MAKE BEFORE POSTING, SENDING OR PROMISING

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Think about the person on the other side.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

BE SOMEONE THE TEAM CAN COUNT ON

> **Reliability matters in the role you have right now.**

The group project is due tomorrow. One person hasn't sent their part. Everyone is worried.

I want you to be the teammate people can count on. Help them know where things stand.

Your Reputation department grows when others can count on you. Know your job, write down the deadline, and do your part.

If you're stuck or running late, speak up early. Give the team time to make a plan.

You can practice this in sports, band, theater, clubs, a job, or at home. You don't have to be the captain to matter.

Come prepared. Listen. Encourage the person who's learning.

If the work isn't being shared fairly, ask the teacher, coach, or leader for help. Being dependable doesn't mean doing everyone's work alone.

Choose one job you can follow through on. A strong team is built by people doing their parts.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can make the team stronger from your place in it.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

MAKE YOUR ROLE CLEAR

> **Give your role a plan and a clear update.**

My role / responsibility	Due date	My next update

WHAT I NEED TO CLARIFY / SUPPORT I WILL ASK FOR

ONE USEFUL WAY I CAN HELP THE TEAM

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A useful update helps the whole team.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

OWN THE MISTAKE. USE THE LESSON.

> **A repair teaches more than an excuse.**

You forgot a promise. Missed a deadline. Said something you wish you hadn't.

Start with the truth: "I said I'd do it, and I didn't. I'm sorry."

Your Reputation department grows when you learn to handle mistakes.

Ask what you can repair. Then change what led to the problem. Put a reminder on your calendar. Prepare earlier. Ask for help before you're stuck.

Think of an athlete watching a rough game. The useful question is, "What can I practice?" Calling yourself terrible isn't a plan.

One apology may not fix everything. Give the other person time and keep showing the change.

I have made mistakes, too. The lesson matters when you use it.

Own your part. Make the repair you can. Practice a better way. You can become stronger at the thing you once got wrong.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can be accountable without giving up on yourself.

DEPARTMENT: REPUTATION

Keep your word. Care about your impact.

TURN A MISTAKE INTO A CHANGE

> **Choose a repair and a better way to follow through.**

Choose a repair and a better process.

WHAT HAPPENED AND THE PART THAT IS MINE

WHAT I CAN FIX / WHO I NEED TO TELL

ONE CHANGE I WILL PRACTICE

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Make the repair. Practice the change.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH

Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

FIND OUT WHAT YOU CAN BECOME

> **Try enough to learn something about yourself.**

You want to try a team or club, but you're worried you won't be good.

How will you find out if you never try?

Your Learning and Growth department is where you discover skills. Explore football, volleyball, cross country, basketball, track, golf, music, art, debate, or a trade class. Start with what interests you and is available.

You don't have to do everything. Choose one thing that fits your life. Ask about help if cost or transport is a problem.

Give yourself time to practice. Listen when a teacher or coach gives useful advice. Ask, "Can you show me?" Then try the change.

You may find a strength. You may learn that you'd rather try something else. Both teach you about yourself.

Being coachable matters. Listen, learn, and try the advice. I want you to give yourself a real chance to find out what you can do.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can discover a strength by giving it a chance.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH

Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

TRY. NOTICE. LEARN.

> **Try something useful and notice what you learn.**

Activity / skill to try	How I can access it	What I will notice

MY FIRST PRACTICE AND WHEN I WILL TRY IT

ONE USEFUL ADJUSTMENT / FEEDBACK I WILL ASK FOR

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A first attempt is a place to learn.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH

Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

ASK SOMEONE WHO HAS BEEN THERE

> **Guidance can show you possibilities you have not seen yet.**

You hear about a job and wonder, "What do they actually do all day?"

Ask someone who knows.

Your Learning and Growth department can learn from people as well as classes.

When I was in high school, I asked adults for guidance. I watched how they worked, spoke, and treated people. It helped me see possibilities.

Ask a counselor or trusted adult to help you find a career talk, school-approved visit, or supervised chance to watch someone work. That is sometimes called job shadowing.

Prepare three questions: What do you do? What skill should I learn first? What is hard about the work?

Show up on time. Listen. Say thank you. Try something useful you learned.

You don't need important connections to start. One honest question can begin a helpful conversation. Let someone show you a possibility you haven't seen yet.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Asking for guidance is a step toward independence.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH
Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

PREPARE TO ASK FOR GUIDANCE

> **A thoughtful question can begin a helpful conversation.**

Prepare an introduction. Ask a trusted adult to help with the connection.

A JOB OR SKILL I WANT TO LEARN ABOUT

A TRUSTED ADULT WHO CAN HELP ARRANGE A CONVERSATION

HOW I WILL INTRODUCE MYSELF AND THREE QUESTIONS

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Be prepared. Be curious. Say thank you.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH

Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

LEARN IT WELL ENOUGH TO USE IT

> **An answer is a beginning. Understanding takes practice.**

You watch a video. The lesson makes sense. But can you do it without the video?

Here's how I want you to test it: give it a try on your own.

Your Learning and Growth department turns information into skills through practice.

Ask a useful question. Learn from a book, teacher, video, or tool you're allowed to use. Then explain the idea in your own words or try a similar task.

If you use AI, follow your teacher's rules. Ask it to explain or help you practice. Don't hand in work you didn't do.

Online answers can be wrong. Check with a reliable source or someone who knows the subject. Keep private details about yourself and others out of your questions.

Stay curious. Ask why. Ask how. Try it yourself.

You don't have to wait for the next class to learn something useful. Start with one question today.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Understanding grows when you put learning to work.

DEPARTMENT: LEARNING AND GROWTH
Explore, practice, and learn from feedback.

TURN INFORMATION INTO A SKILL

> **Check your understanding by trying it yourself.**

Learn, check, and practice one useful thing.

MY QUESTION AND WHERE I WILL LOOK FOR AN ANSWER

WHAT I LEARNED AND HOW I CHECKED IT

WHAT I WILL TRY OR EXPLAIN ON MY OWN

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Put one new thing into practice.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

GIVE YOUR FUTURE A REASON

> **You can build for a life you have not lived yet.**

Some days you won't feel like doing the work.

That's when it helps to remember why you started.

Your Purpose department holds your reason. Purpose simply means why something matters to you.

In high school, I thought about the family I hoped to have one day. I wanted to become someone they could count on. That gave my choices a reason.

Your reason can be different. "I want to be proud of myself." "I want more choices." "I want to help my family." I mean that. Your reason doesn't have to impress anyone. It needs to matter to you.

You don't need a career picked out to have a purpose. You can decide to become someone who learns, helps, and follows through.

Write your reason. Connect it to one small action.

When the work feels hard, come back to that reason. Let it help you take your next step.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A simple reason can help you keep going.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

WRITE YOUR REASON

> **Choose a reason that means something to you.**

Write a reason you can return to when the work gets difficult.

WHO OR WHAT I AM BUILDING FOR

THE KIND OF PERSON I WANT TO BECOME

MY REASON / ONE ACTION THAT SHOWS IT

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Let your reason show up in a choice.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

CHOOSE A PATH THAT FITS YOU

> **Your next step should have a reason beyond someone else's approval.**

"What are you doing after graduation?"

You may not know yet. I don't expect you to. I do want you to start exploring what is possible.

Your Purpose department helps you look for a path that fits your interests and goals.

College, job training, an apprenticeship, work, military service, or building a business can lead in different directions. Learn what each path asks of you.

Choose two to explore. Compare what you'd learn, the time, the cost, and who could help. A counselor can help you find reliable details.

Freshman? Ask about a class or activity that lets you test an interest. Senior? Find the next deadline and put it on your calendar.

Don't choose a path only because a friend chose it. Don't rule yourself out before asking questions.

You are allowed to learn, change your mind, and make a thoughtful next choice.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

An informed next step is enough to begin.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

COMPARE TWO POSSIBLE NEXT STEPS

> **Compare the next steps, not your whole worth.**

What I want to compare	Route A	Route B
Name of route		
Skills / work involved		
Cost / time / requirements		
Help I can ask for		

A QUESTION TO CHECK WITH A COUNSELOR OR TRUSTED ADULT

MY NEXT STEP AND WHEN

A REMINDER FOR YOU

You can explore before deciding.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

BE AN ASSET TO YOUR COMMUNITY

> **You can make a place better before you have a title.**

You see trash near the school entrance. A new student is sitting alone. Someone needs help setting up an event.

You can be a person who helps. I believe that when we become better, the people around us should benefit, too.

Your Purpose department reaches beyond your own goals. When you build useful skills, you have more ways to care for people around you.

Try student council, a school club, a community cleanup, or a volunteer event that fits your age and schedule. Ask your school or a trusted group how to join.

Small help counts, too. Welcome someone. Take care of a shared space. Finish a useful job at home.

Ask what would help. Listen. Follow through. You don't need to post every kind thing you do.

Service gives you practice in teamwork and responsibility. It also helps make your community a better place.

Look around. Choose one way to contribute.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A community grows through ordinary acts of care.

DEPARTMENT: PURPOSE

Know your reason. Let it guide your choices.

DO SOMETHING USEFUL FOR SOMEONE

> **Help with something people actually need.**

Choose a useful act of service that fits your life.

ONE WAY SOMEONE OR SOMEWHERE NEEDS HELP

HOW I CAN HELP / WHO I WILL ASK

WHEN I WILL HELP / WHAT I LEARNED

A REMINDER FOR YOU

A useful act of kindness matters.

DEPARTMENT: COMPANY REVIEW

Notice progress. Adjust the next plan.

LOOK AT WHAT IS ACTUALLY CHANGING

> **Give your progress evidence you can come back to.**

Take a minute with me. Let's look at what you've been building.

Go back to your first company checkup and your midpoint checkup. Use the same guide to score your departments again.

Then write what changed. Did you start work earlier? Ask more questions? Keep a promise? Put some money aside?

Real examples tell you more than a score alone.

Look at the goal you chose in Entry 3. What did you try? What helped? What needs a different plan?

Some habits need more time. If life got harder, include that in your review. You may need a smaller step or more help.

Use your company report to record what you've learned. Then choose one department to keep working on.

A good CEO pays attention and adjusts. Be proud of the work you've done. Use what it taught you.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your review should help you decide what comes next.

DEPARTMENT: COMPANY REVIEW

Notice progress. Adjust the next plan.

YOUR COMPANY: THEN AND NOW

> **Let the evidence guide your next decision.**

Copy your Entry 2 scores and midpoint scores from the checkup after Entry 15. Score now with the same guide. Leave unknowns blank.

Department	Start	Midpoint	Now
Time and Habits			
Leadership			
Money			
Health and Energy			
Relationships			
Reputation			
Learning and Growth			
Purpose			

MY STRONGEST EVIDENCE OF CHANGE

If life became harder, include that context. Choose a smaller step or more support where needed. This is information for your next plan.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Keep the evidence of your effort.

DEPARTMENT: YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY

See your whole company. Choose a starting point.

YOUR PERSONAL COMPANY REPORT

> **Record the changes you can actually point to.**

Goal / progress number	Where I started	Where I am now

A GOAL OR MILESTONE REACHED / THE EVIDENCE

A HABIT: DONE / PLANNED IN MY LATEST WEEK

A LESSON OR REPAIR I HAVE PUT INTO ACTION

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION / MY NEXT PRIORITY

Keep this report with your first checkup. Entry 30 helps you plan the next 90 days. Keep using the daily check-in and weekly board meeting after you finish reading.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Keep the evidence. Carry the lesson forward.

DEPARTMENT: COMPANY REVIEW AND NEXT STEPS

Notice progress. Adjust the next plan.

YOUR FUTURE IS STILL BEING BUILT

> **You can keep building long after the last page.**

You've reached the last entry. Your company is still being built.

That is good news. You still have things to try, skills to discover, and people to learn from.

I am still building, too. I'm sharing this from my heart because I want you to see what is possible. I don't expect you to have everything figured out after thirty entries.

Keep using the daily check-in and weekly review. Use a calendar. Ask questions. Come back to a lesson when you need it.

Choose one priority for your next 90 days. Maybe it's a homework routine, a skill, an activity, or a plan for after graduation.

Break it into smaller steps. Put the next week's action on your calendar. Review it each week and adjust.

Freshman or senior, you can take a useful step from where you are.

You are the CEO of you. Keep learning. Keep building. Give yourself a future you can be proud of.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Keep building, one good choice at a time.

DEPARTMENT: COMPANY REVIEW AND NEXT STEPS

Notice progress. Adjust the next plan.

YOUR NEXT 90 DAYS

> **One priority. Useful actions. A regular review.**

PRIORITY DEPARTMENT AND ONE RESULT I WANT

Progress number	Starting point	90-day target

By day 30	By day 60	By day 90

MY NEXT SEVEN-DAY ACTION AND ITS CALENDAR TIME

OBSTACLE / SMALLER BACKUP STEP / WHO CAN HELP

WEEKLY REVIEW TIME / 90-DAY REVIEW DATE

Keep using your daily check-in and weekly review. Adjust as your life changes.

A REMINDER FOR YOU

Your next choice is still yours to make.